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# Reporting guidance for 'No-presence' data on food additives and food flavourings at sample level - 2026

## Data model elements

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## Abstract

This document should be used for the reporting to EFSA of the no-presence of food additives and food flavourings in samples. It provides guidance on how to use the data model and gives information on the different data elements and business rules. It also provides guidance on the preparation, submission, validation and acceptance of the data.

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**Keywords:** data model, no-presence, pilot, monitoring programme, sample

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**Correspondence:** [Ask a Question](#)



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# 1 Introduction

## 1.1 Background

Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008<sup>1</sup> and Regulation (EC) No 1334/2008<sup>2</sup> lay down rules on food additives (FA) and food flavourings (FF) used in foods with a view to ensure the effective functioning of the internal market whilst ensuring a high level of protection of human health. These regulations aim to protect consumer interests and fair practices in food trade, protecting the environment where feasible, also providing a list of FA/FF and source materials approved for use in and on foods, conditions of use of such substances and rules on the labelling of FA/FF sold as such.

The objective of the monitoring of the consumption and the use of FA/FF is to gather data on their intake and to assess that their use does not raise a health concern. This monitoring helps in verifying the dietary intakes estimated at the time of establishment of the authorisation or re-evaluation. The monitoring is also a relevant information source for future risk management measures. Finally, the data collected during the monitoring could be used for future risk assessment purposes, e.g., to assess the combined exposure to multiple chemicals. To achieve this objective, a common terminology and methodology need to be implemented.

For such purpose, European Commission requested to EFSA to open a yearly data collection on FA/FF ([M-2022-00210](#)), starting with a pilot in 2025.

Following the Commission Recommendation (EU) 2023/965<sup>3</sup> on the methodology for the monitoring of FA/FF intake, MS should collect at least one of the following types of data:

- (a) Analytical data: concentration of FA/FF measured in food.
- (b) Use levels: concentration of FA/FF reported by business operators to be added to food.

MS may also collect (c) presence data, i.e., data on the presence or the absence of a specific FA/FF in a foodstuff. Since the collected data should allow for the calculation of the FA/FF intake, the collection of presence data alone is not sufficient, and MS should collect at least one type of occurrence data (analytical data or use levels). However, it is recommended to also collect presence data to identify whether a FA/FF is used or not used in a particular foodstuff.

Analytical data on FA/FF together with presence data at sample level should be submitted to EFSA using the SSD2 (Standard Sample Description version 2) format (for FF starting from 2025) (EFSA, 2025a). For technical reasons, the reporting of 'no-presence' data alone is not supported by the analytical data model (SSD2). For this reason, EFSA developed the new data model (DM) for collecting this type of data (EFSA, 2025b) and the present guidance contains the data model version that has been improved based on the first pilot. This data model covers the submission

<sup>1</sup> Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 16 December 2008 on food additives; document available at <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/PDF/?uri=CELEX:32008R1333>

<sup>2</sup> Regulation (EC) No 1334/2008 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 16 December 2008 on flavourings and certain food ingredients with flavouring properties for use in and on foods and amending Council Regulation (EEC) No 1601/91, Regulations (EC) No 2232/96 and (EC) No 110/2008 and Directive 2000/13/EC; document available at <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/LexUriServ/LexUriServ.do?uri=OJ:L:2008:354:0034:0050:en:PDF>

<sup>3</sup> Commission Recommendation (EU) 2023/965 of 12 May 2023 on the methodology for the monitoring of food additive and food flavouring intake. OJEU L 129, 16 May 2023 p. 17



of presence data at sample level to report that a specific FA/FF has not been used. If the FA/FF is reported on the label and/or there is evidence of its use, the positive presence should be submitted to EFSA using the SSD2 format together with an analytical measurement.

The 'no-presence' DM has been already piloted in 2025, and it will be piloted in 2026. The piloting involved three FA and on two FF for 2025 and is going to involve two FA and three FF for 2026<sup>4</sup>. The result of the pilot 2025 has been assessed and considered to further adjust and improve the DM described in the present document.

Reporting countries (RC) will be given the possibility to transmit eXtensible Markup Language (XML) data files through the EFSA Data Collection Framework (DCF). The present DM is in accordance with the harmonised terminology of EFSA and, where applicable, with the terminology used in the EFSA Standard Sample Description (SSD2) of the annual Chemical Monitoring (ChemMon) data collection.

A detailed description of the data elements required by this DM and of the related set of Business Rules (BR) applied for data validation is reported in the last sections of the current document.

<sup>4</sup> Pilot 2025: green S (E 142), tartrazine (E 102), ponceau 4R/cochineal red A (E 124), caffeine (16.016), pulegone (Annex III)

Pilot 2026: butylated hydroxytoluene (BHT) (E 321), sorbic acid – sorbates (E 200 – 203), coumarin (Annex III), hydrocyanic acid (Annex III), theobromine (16.032)

## 2 Data elements

The focus of this section is on the data elements required for the preparation of monitoring reports data as well as those needed for dietary exposure assessments.

At the end of the present guidance, Table 1 provides the full list of the SSD2-derived data elements along with their applicability and the concerned controlled terminology (catalogues).

### 2.1 Programme legal reference (progLegalRef) (mandatory)

This data element is used to specify the legal framework under which the sampling is planned. The codes are linked to the catalogue LEGREF and must be selected from the 'faff' hierarchy. The only applicable codes are:

- N112A – Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008<sup>1</sup> of the European Parliament and of the Council of 16 December 2008 on food additives;
- N113A - Regulation (EC) No 1334/2008<sup>2</sup> of the European Parliament and of the Council of 16 December 2008 on flavourings and certain food ingredients with flavouring properties for use in and on foods.

| Example         | XML                                  |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------|
| Additive domain | <progLegalRef>N112A</ progLegalRef > |

### 2.2 Sample taken identification code (sampId) (mandatory)

Each sample must be identified by a unique code. The unique identification code cannot exceed 100 characters and special characters must be avoided. Where multiple records are reported for the same sample (e.g., records for different substances), the same sampId must be reported.

| Example                                             | XML                                 |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Unique identifier for a category from 2026 in Italy | <sampId>IT_2026_mozzarella</sampId> |

### 2.3 Reporting country (repCountry) (optional)

This data element contains information on the country reporting the data. Codes can be selected from the COUNTRY catalogue. If not present, this data element will be automatically populated by EFSA with the country of the reporting organization.

### 2.4 Sampling country (sampCountry) (mandatory)

This data element is reported using the ISO 3166-1-alpha-2 country codes for the country where the sample was taken. Codes can be selected from the COUNTRY catalogue.

| Example                     | XML                             |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------|
| Spanish competent authority | <sampCountry>ES</ sampCountry > |



## 2.5 Reporting year (repYear) (optional)

This data element is used to provide the reporting year, which must be equal to the current year of the data collection, e.g., during the 2026 data collection, the reporting year must be 2026.

| Example                    | XML                     |
|----------------------------|-------------------------|
| 2026 Pilot data collection | <repYear>2026</repYear> |

## 2.6 Year of sampling (sampY) (mandatory) Month of sampling (sampM) (mandatory) Day of sampling (sampD) (mandatory)

Date of monitoring of the 'no-presence' data is mandatory to be reported by using the year (Y), month (M) and day (D) data elements. The sampling year (sampY) should be equal to the calendar year of the data collection -1. In case the sampling has been performed over a period of time the start date of sampling should be reported.

| Example                    | XML                 |
|----------------------------|---------------------|
| 2026 Pilot data collection | <sampY>2025</sampY> |

## 2.7 Coded description of the matrix of the sample taken (sampMatCode) (mandatory)

This data element should be used to describe the sample taken. Samples in FoodEx2 must be encoded according to the guidance for the harmonised use of the FoodEx2 system and the quality control of the codes (EFSA, 2015). To describe the sample reported, the code reflecting the highest level of detail is normally used, meaning the code that provides as much details as possible. FoodEx2 codes can be selected from the MTX catalogue using the reporting hierarchy.

FoodEx2 requires that a base term is always supplied. If the implicit facets are enough to characterise the sample, only the base term needs to be reported.

This mandatory data element is also used to report the food legislative category, of the reported sample according to version 7 of Annex II to Reg. 1333/2008<sup>5</sup>. To do so, one facet must always be present: the food legislative category (facet F33). F33 must be reported for both domains, additives and flavourings. In most of the cases, facet 33 is already pre-assigned in the codes present in the reporting hierarchy as implicit facets. If the F33 facet is not implicitly assigned, it is up to the DP to explicitly assign it. The legislative category "All categories of foods" is not allowed to be reported.

This data element is also used to indicate the physical state of the reported sample such as granules, tablets, liquid, powder, etc. This information must be reported using the facet 03 (F03) – physical state. In some cases, the F03 facet is already pre-assigned as implicit facet to the FoodEx2 base terms; if the F03 is not implicitly assigned, it is up to the DP to explicitly assign it for the following food legislative categories:

<sup>5</sup> Guidance document describing the food categories in Part E of Annex II to Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008 on Food Additives (version 7): [https://food.ec.europa.eu/system/files/2022-12/fs\\_food-improvement-agents\\_guidance\\_1333-2008\\_annex-2.pdf](https://food.ec.europa.eu/system/files/2022-12/fs_food-improvement-agents_guidance_1333-2008_annex-2.pdf)

- 01.5 Dehydrated milk as defined by Directive 2001/114/EC
- 01.6 Cream and cream powder
- 01.8 Dairy analogues, including beverage whiteners
- 01.9 Edible caseinates
- 01.10 Milk-based drinks and similar products intended for young children
- 06.3 Breakfast cereals
- 12.5 Soups and broths
- 12.6 Sauces
- 13 Foods intended for specific groups as defined by Regulation (EU) No 609/2013
- 14.1.2 Fruit juices as defined by Directive 2001/112/EC and vegetable juices
- 14.1.3 Fruit nectars as defined by Directive 2001/112/EC and vegetable nectars and similar products
- 14.1.4 Flavoured drinks
- 14.1.5 Coffee, coffee and chicory extracts, tea, herbal- and fruit-infusions; coffee substitutes, coffee mixes and mixes for 'hot beverages'
- 17. Food supplements as defined in Directive 2002/46/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council excluding food supplements for infants and young children

Moreover, if the product is formulated for infants (<12 months), belonging to the food category '13. Foods intended for particular nutritional uses as defined by Directive 2009/39/EC', the target-consumer facet (F23) should be added to the code, specifying this information.

| Example of matCode reported                                                                                              | Implicit and explicit facets code in the reported matCode                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Note |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| <b>Base term selected:</b><br>A03QH = 'Infant formula, milk and soya-based, liquid'<br><br><b>Correct code:</b><br>A03QH | <b>Implicit facets:</b><br>F02: Part-nature = 'Infant formulae (as part-nature)'<br>F03: Physical-state = 'Liquid'<br>F04: Ingredient = 'Milk'<br>F04: Ingredient = 'Soya proteins'<br>F23: Target-consumer = 'Infant or toddler food'<br>F33: Legislative-classes = 'FA-13.1.1 Infant formulae as defined by Commission Directive 2006/141/EC (1)' |      |
| <b>Base term selected:</b><br>A03MX = 'Wine, red'<br><br><b>Correct code:</b><br>A03MX                                   | <b>Implicit facets:</b><br>F02: Part-nature = 'Wine (as part-nature)'<br>F10: Qualitative-Info = 'Red'<br>F27: Source-Commodities = 'Wine grapes'<br>F28: Process = 'Winemaking'<br>F33: Legislative classes = 'FA-14.2.2 Wine and other products defined by Regulation (EEC) No 1234/2007, and alcohol-free counterparts'                          |      |



| Example of matCode reported                                                                            | Implicit and explicit facets code in the reported matCode                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Note                                                                                                                                                             |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Base term selected:</b><br>A02RH = 'Soft-ripened cheese'<br><br><b>Correct code:</b><br>A02RH       | <b>Implicit facets:</b><br>F02: Part-nature = 'Ripened cheese (as part-nature)'<br>F10: Qualitative-Info = 'Soft'<br>F27: Source-Commodities = 'Milk'<br>F28: Process = 'Cheesemaking'<br>F28: Process = 'Ripening'<br><b>F33:</b> Legislative classes = 'FA-01.7.2 Ripened cheese' |                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Base term selected:</b><br>A03YN = 'Omelette, plain'<br><br><b>Correct code:</b><br>A03YN#F33.A0C33 | <b>Implicit facets:</b><br>F02: Part-nature = 'Egg based dishes (as part-nature)'<br>F04: Ingredient = 'Whole eggs'<br><br><b>Explicit facets:</b><br><b>F33:</b> Legislative classes = 'FA- 10.2 Processed eggs and egg products'                                                  | Correct coding: based on the explicit F33 facet code added to the base term A03YN this product will be classified in the food additive legislative category 10.2 |

## 2.8 Textual description of the matrix of the sample (sampMatText) (optional)

After describing the matrix with the most detailed level of information available using FoodEx2, the sampMatText field can be used to report a full textual description of the sample and to provide additional relevant information. This will provide a possibility of crosschecking for the codes reported and could highlight any data quality problem at data analysis level.

By default, if left empty, this data element is going to be populated with the text associated to the sampMatCode selected.

## 2.9 Restriction or exception (restrictionException) (mandatory)

This mandatory data element should be used to provide the restrictions/exceptions as described in the Regulation (EC) No 1333/2008<sup>1</sup> for each authorised FA across the different additive food categories. This data element can also be used for FF in the case Regulation (EC) No 1334/2008<sup>2</sup> describes restrictions/exceptions for their use.

The codes are linked to the catalogue ADDFOOD and should be selected from the specific hierarchy: 'FARestExc' for FA and 'FFRestExc' for FF. The most detailed category that defines the restriction/exception with the corresponding code should be chosen and reported in this data element.

Few examples are described below:

- If mozzarella cheese is the sample for which the no-presence data of lactic acid is going to be reported, then the restriction would be 'only mozzarella' of the category '1.7.1 Unripened cheese excluding products falling in category 16'.
- If milk chocolate is the sample for which the no-presence data of citric acid is going to be reported, the restriction would be 'only milk chocolate' falling in category '5.1 Cocoa and Chocolate products as covered by Directive 2000/36/EC'.

- If tuna fish is the sample for which ascorbic acid no-presence data is going to be reported, the restriction would be 'only tuna' falling in category '9.2 Processed fish and fishery products including molluscs and crustaceans'.

- If there are not restrictions/exceptions, then the option 'No restriction/exception to report' will need to be reported.

| Example                                                                                                                 | XML                                                    |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|
| Only mozzarella<br>(Food legislative category: 1.7.1 Unripened cheese excluding products falling in category 16)        | <restrictionException>ADD00197A</restrictionException> |
| Only milk chocolate<br>(Food legislative category: 5.1 Cocoa and Chocolate products as covered by Directive 2000/36/EC) | <restrictionException>ADD00386A</restrictionException> |
| Only tuna<br>(Food legislative category: 9.2 Processed fish and fishery products including molluscs and crustaceans)    | <restrictionException>ADD00622A</restrictionException> |
| No restriction/exception to report                                                                                      | <restrictionException>ADD00881A</restrictionException> |

## 2.10 Brand name (sampMatInfo.brandName) (optional)

This optional data element, if information is available, can be provided for every record in the dataset. It is used to indicate the brand name of the reported sample.

## 2.11 Manufacturer name (sampMatInfo.manuf) (optional)

This optional data element, if information is available, can be provided for every record in the dataset. It is used to indicate the company manufacturer of the reported sample.

## 2.12 Parameter code (paramCode) (mandatory)

This element specifies the code of the substance reported (not identified on the label or not added). The selected code must be present in the 'addAnalysis' (Food additives domain) or 'flavAnalysis' (Food flavourings domain) hierarchies, otherwise the data cannot be transmitted. In case more than one substance is going to be reported as not present on the label or not added for the same sample, the additional substance should be reported by creating a new record (row in the excel template) using the same sampId (see 2.2) while a different resId (see 2.14).

| Example                   | XML                                    |
|---------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| paramCode for Acetic Acid | <paramCode>RF-00000019-ADD</paramCode> |
| paramCode for 1-butanol   | <paramCode>RF-00004837-PAR</paramCode> |

## 2.13 Parameter text (paramText) (optional)

This data element is used to specify the name of the FA/FF for which the paramCode was reported. By default, if not present, it will be automatically populated by EFSA with the name of the paramCode reported.

## 2.14 Result identification code (resId) (mandatory)

This data element must be provided for every record in the dataset. It must be unique across all data collections from the very same DP. This identifier is used also for communication between EFSA and the DP during the transmission and validation phases. When validating data, it is essential to be able to detect the records counted and to identify those that may need to be amended.

It is recommended that certain prefixes or suffixes are included to ensure the resId is unique within a particular DP.

| Example                                                           | XML                                 |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Record for food additives reported by a Finnish authority in 2026 | <resId>FI_FALab2026_0006754</resId> |

## 2.15 Presence/Added (presenceAdded) (mandatory)

This data element indicates whether the FA/FF is present and/or added in the reported sample. The use of a FA in a food product should be indicated by law on the label, except for FA without technological role in the final product e.g., carriers (Article 20 Regulation 1169/2011<sup>6</sup>) and FA with nutritional purpose (Regulation 1925/2006<sup>7</sup>); for FF there is no legal requirement on labelling.

The code to be used is in the CONCLUS catalogue selecting the faff hierarchy. The only option admitted is C20A ('No, not present on label/not added').

The collection of these data might be used to refine dietary exposure estimations to FA/FF. If the information reported under this data element is 'No, not present on label/not added', this might be used as evidence that for a particular food within a food category a FA/FF was not used.

Positive presence data ('Yes, present on label/added') are not accepted in this model. Positive presence data should always be submitted together with analytical/use levels.

For FA/FF the following options can be provided:

- If the FA/FF is not reported on the label or there is evidence of not being used, 'No, not present on label/not added'.

| Example                                  | XML                                 |
|------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| The additive is not present on the label | <presenceAdded>C20A</presenceAdded> |

<sup>6</sup> Regulation (EU) No 1169/2011 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 25 October 2011 on the provision of food information to consumers, amending Regulations (EC) No 1924/2006 and (EC) No 1925/2006 of the European Parliament and of the Council, and repealing Commission Directive 87/250/EEC, Council Directive 90/496/EEC, Commission Directive 1999/10/EC, Directive 2000/13/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council, Commission Directives 2002/67/EC and 2008/5/EC and Commission Regulation (EC) No 608/2004

<sup>7</sup> Regulation (EC) No 1925/2006 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 20 December 2006 on the addition of vitamins and minerals and of certain other substances to foods



### 2.16 Function of the substance (functionOf) (dependent mandatory)

This dependent mandatory data element is used to indicate the functional class of the FA and, therefore, is required only for the food additives domain. The allowed data elements are available from the FUNC catalogue, and those applicable for FA are listed in Table 2.

| Example                                          | XML                            |
|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Food additive belonging to the emulsifiers group | <functionOf>emu</ functionOf > |

### 3 Methodologies

National food authorities, research institutions, academia, food business operators and other interested stakeholders can designate a list of experts for sending data to EFSA. Multiple experts from the same stakeholder can be nominated as a Data Provider (DP) and/or Data Validator (DV). The expert nominated as DP shall access the Data Collection Framework (DCF) with EFSA credentials for sending data. Once logged in to the DCF, the designated DP, will have access to the folder to transmit at least one data file.

As regarding **data preparation**, each DP shall compile and report data to EFSA using the Excel reporting tool for no-presence data at sample level ([10.5281/zenodo.14893698](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.14893698)). Once the reporting tool has been completed with the relevant information, as described in the previous paragraphs, the file shall be exported in XML format.

For **data submission**, the XML file need to be uploaded in the EFSA DCF platform (<https://dcf.efsa.europa.eu/dcf-war/dc>) using the 'Insert New Dataset' button. Once the dataset has been assigned with a dataset Id and the 'processing' is finalised, the status of the dataset will be shown as:

- Rejected: dataset does not comply with the schema or wrong format.
- Rejected editable: dataset triggers BRs that are errors (Table 3).
- Valid with warnings: dataset triggers BRs that are warnings (Table 3).
- Valid: no BRs are triggered.

In case of status 'Rejected', 'Rejected editable' and 'Valid with warnings', DP can select the 'Ack view' button that provides information on the dataset and a summary of errors/warnings are presented at the end. If more detailed information is needed, the 'Ack details' button should be used.

After all identified errors have been addressed, the file can be newly uploaded to DCF replacing the existing dataset with the new data file by selecting 'Replace'.

Only datasets in status 'Valid' or 'Valid with warnings' can be submitted to the EFSA scientific DataWareHouse (sDWH). Each DP shall submit these datasets to make them available in the sDWH.

The final step consists of **data validation** in [MicroStrategy platform](#). All submitted data will be visible to specific validation dashboards, one day after submitting the dataset in DCF. DV can accept or reject the data in the Confirmation document, by selecting the final status of the datasets, 'Accepted' or 'Rejected', from the drop-down menu 'Confirm-Reject', in correspondence with the relative dataset ID. Once the DVs are satisfied with the accuracy and completeness of the datasets, they will be able to 'Accept' the data to ensure that data are in the EFSA sDWH and ready for use. At the end of the process, the DV must submit the final status of the datasets by clicking the 'Submit' button.

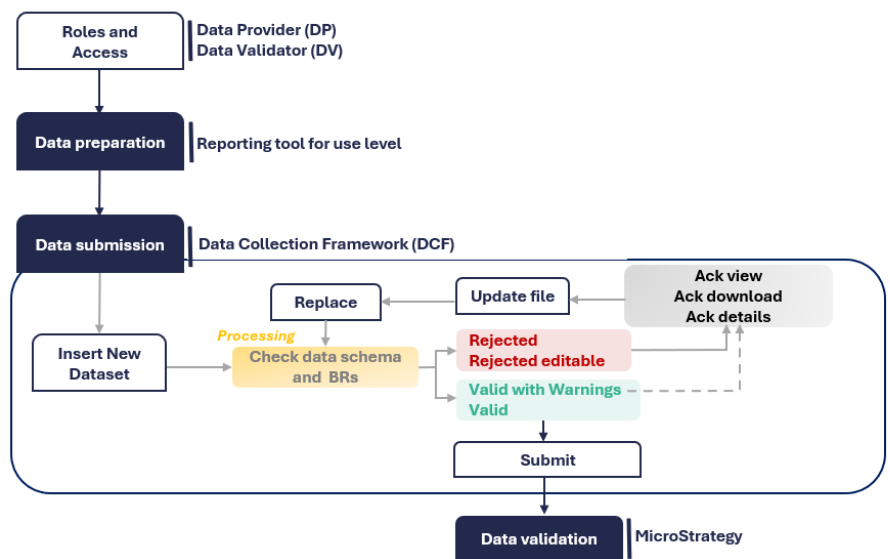


Figure 1. Data flow on the preparation, submission, validation and acceptance of the data

# Guidance for reporting 'no-presence' data on food additives and food flavourings - 2026

Table 1: List of the data elements of the 'no-presence' data model for the annual collection of FA/FF

| Element label                                              | Element name         | Type            | Controlled terminology | Mandatory/Optional | Notes                                                                                                                             | Business rule code               |
|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------|------------------------|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Programme legal reference</b>                           | progLegalRef         | xs:string (5)   | <b>LEGREF</b>          | <b>Mandatory</b>   | Only codes from the LEGREF.faff hierarchy can be reported.                                                                        | PRE13<br>PRE14                   |
| <b>Sample taken identification code</b>                    | sampId               | xs:string (100) |                        | <b>Mandatory</b>   |                                                                                                                                   | PRE11<br>PRE12                   |
| <b>Reporting country</b>                                   | repCountry           | xs:string (2)   | <b>COUNTRY</b>         | Optional           |                                                                                                                                   |                                  |
| <b>Sampling country</b>                                    | sampCountry          | xs:string (2)   | <b>COUNTRY</b>         | <b>Mandatory</b>   | Only codes from the COUNTRY catalogue.                                                                                            |                                  |
| <b>Reporting year</b>                                      | repYear              | xs:integer (4)  |                        | Optional           |                                                                                                                                   | PRE16                            |
| <b>Year of sampling</b>                                    | sampY                | xs:integer (4)  |                        | <b>Mandatory</b>   |                                                                                                                                   | PRE01<br>PRE17                   |
| <b>Month of sampling</b>                                   | sampM                | xs:integer (2)  |                        | <b>Mandatory</b>   |                                                                                                                                   | PRE17                            |
| <b>Day of sampling</b>                                     | sampD                | xs:integer (2)  |                        | <b>Mandatory</b>   |                                                                                                                                   | PRE17                            |
| <b>Coded description of the matrix of the sample taken</b> | sampMatCode          | xs:compoundType | <b>MTX</b>             | <b>Mandatory</b>   |                                                                                                                                   | PRE02<br>PRE08<br>PRE09<br>PRE15 |
| <b>Textual description of the matrix of the sample</b>     | sampMatText          | xs:string (400) |                        | Optional           |                                                                                                                                   |                                  |
| <b>Restriction or exception</b>                            | restrictionException | xs:string (9)   | <b>ADDFOOD</b>         | <b>Mandatory</b>   | Only codes reportable under FAREstExc/FFRestExc hierarchies can be reported respectively for the additive and flavouring domains. | PRE03<br>PRE04                   |

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| Element label                     | Element name          | Type            | Controlled terminology | Mandatory/Optional         | Notes                                                                                                                                          | Business rule code               |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------|-----------------|------------------------|----------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|
| <b>Brand name</b>                 | sampMatInfo.brandName | xs:string (250) |                        | Optional                   |                                                                                                                                                |                                  |
| <b>Manufacturer name</b>          | sampMatInfo.manuf     | xs:string (250) |                        | Optional                   |                                                                                                                                                |                                  |
| <b>Parameter code</b>             | paramCode             | xs:string (400) | <b>PARAM</b>           | <b>Mandatory</b>           | Only codes from the addAnalysis/flavAnalysis hierarchies can be reported.                                                                      | PRE05<br>PRE12<br>PRE13<br>PRE14 |
| <b>Parameter text</b>             | paramText             | xs:string (400) |                        | Optional                   |                                                                                                                                                |                                  |
| <b>Result identification code</b> | resId                 | xs:string (100) |                        | <b>Mandatory</b>           |                                                                                                                                                |                                  |
| <b>Presence/Added</b>             | presenceAdded         | xs:repeatable   | <b>CONCLUS</b>         | <b>Mandatory</b>           | Only 'No-presence' information can be reported in this data model. Positive presence needs to be accompanied by an analytical/use level value. | PRE06<br>PRE10                   |
| <b>Function of the substance</b>  | functionOf            | xs:repeatable   | <b>FUNC</b>            | <b>Dependent mandatory</b> | It is mandatory only for the additive domain.                                                                                                  | PRE07                            |



Table 2: List of food additive classes

| Food Additive class number | Food additive class name                 | Food additive class information                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|----------------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1                          | sweeteners                               | Substances used to impart a sweet taste to foods or in table-top sweeteners.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
| 2                          | colours                                  | Substances which add or restore colour in a food, and include natural constituents of foods and natural sources which are normally not consumed as foods as such and not normally used as characteristic ingredients of food. Preparations obtained from foods and other edible natural source materials obtained by physical and/or chemical extraction resulting in a selective extraction of the pigments relative to the nutritive or aromatic constituents are colours within the meaning of this Regulation. |
| 3                          | preservatives                            | Substances which prolong the shelf-life of foods by protecting them against deterioration caused by micro-organisms and/or which protect against growth of pathogenic micro-organisms.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 4                          | antioxidants                             | Substances which prolong the shelf-life of foods by protecting them against deterioration caused by oxidation, such as fat rancidity and colour changes.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 5                          | carriers                                 | Substances used to dissolve, dilute, disperse or otherwise physically modify a food additive or a flavouring, food enzyme, nutrient and/or other substance added for nutritional or physiological purposes to a food without altering its function (and without exerting any technological effect themselves) in order to facilitate its handling, application or use.                                                                                                                                             |
| 6                          | acids                                    | Substances which increase the acidity of a foodstuff and/or impart a sour taste to it.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
| 7                          | acidity regulators                       | Substances which alter or control the acidity or alkalinity of a foodstuff.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 8                          | anti-caking agents                       | Substances which reduce the tendency of individual particles of a foodstuff to adhere to one another.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 9                          | anti-foaming agents                      | Substances which prevent or reduce foaming.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 10                         | bulking agents                           | Substances which contribute to the volume of a foodstuff without contributing significantly to its available energy value.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 11                         | emulsifiers                              | Substances which make it possible to form or maintain a homogenous mixture of two or more immiscible phases such as oil and water in a foodstuff.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 12                         | emulsifying salts                        | Substances which convert proteins contained in cheese into a dispersed form and thereby bring about homogenous distribution of fat and other components.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 13                         | firming agents                           | Substances which make or keep tissues of fruit or vegetables firm or crisp, or interact with gelling agents to produce or strengthen a gel.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 14                         | flavour enhancers                        | Substances which enhance the existing taste and/or odour of a foodstuff.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| 15                         | foaming agents                           | Substances which make it possible to form a homogenous dispersion of a gaseous phase in a liquid or solid foodstuff.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 16                         | gelling agents                           | Substances which give a foodstuff texture through formation of a gel.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 17                         | glazing agents<br>(including lubricants) | Substances which, when applied to the external surface of a foodstuff, impart a shiny appearance or provide a protective coating.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |
| 18                         | humectants                               | Substances which prevent foods from drying out by counteracting the effect of an atmosphere having a low degree of humidity, or promote the dissolution of a powder in an aqueous medium.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |

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| Food Additive class number | Food additive class name                                          | Food additive class information                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 19                         | modified starches                                                 | Substances obtained by one or more chemical treatments of edible starches, which may have undergone a physical or enzymatic treatment, and may be acid or alkali thinned or bleached.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |
| 20                         | packaging gases                                                   | Gases other than air, introduced into a container before, during or after the placing of a foodstuff in that container.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 21                         | propellants                                                       | Gases other than air which expel a foodstuff from a container.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
| 22                         | raising agents                                                    | Substances or combinations of substances which liberate gas and thereby increase the volume of a dough or a batter.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
| 23                         | sequestrants                                                      | Substances which form chemical complexes with metallic ions.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 24                         | stabilisers                                                       | Substances which make it possible to maintain the physico-chemical state of a foodstuff; stabilisers include substances which enable the maintenance of a homogenous dispersion of two or more immiscible substances in a foodstuff, substances which stabilise, retain or intensify an existing colour of a foodstuff and substances which increase the binding capacity of the food, including the formation of cross-links between proteins enabling the binding of food pieces into re-constituted food. |
| 25                         | thickeners                                                        | Substances which increase the viscosity of a foodstuff.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
| 26                         | flour treatment agents                                            | Substances, other than emulsifiers, which are added to flour or dough to improve its baking quality.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 27                         | contrast enhancers                                                | Substances which, when applied to the external surface of fruit or vegetables following depigmentation of predefined parts (e.g. by laser treatment), help to distinguish these parts from the remaining surface by imparting colour following interaction with certain components of the epidermis.                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
| 28                         | nutrient                                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 29                         | Annex III – Carriers in food additives                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 30                         | Annex III – Food additives other than carriers in food additives  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 31                         | Annex III – Food additives including carriers in food enzymes     |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 32                         | Annex III - Food additives including carriers in food flavourings |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
| 33                         | Annex III – Food additives in nutrients                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |

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Table 3: List of the business rules applicable

| Business rule code | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Error/Warning message                                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Type of error | Status |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------|--------|
| <b>PRE01</b>       | The sampling year (sampY) should be equal to the calendar year of the data collection -1.                                                                                                                                                                                                      | The sampling year (sampY) is not equal to the calendar year of the data collection -1.                                                                                                                                                            | Error         | Active |
| <b>PRE02</b>       | The target consumer facet (F23) must be reported under the coded description of the matrix (sampMatCode) if the sample refers to the following food legislative category (matCode.F33): 13 – Foods intended for particular nutritional uses as defined by Directive 2009/39/EC.                | The target consumer facet (F23) is not reported when the food legislative category is 13 – Foods intended for particular nutritional uses as defined by Directive 2009/39/EC.                                                                     | Error         | Active |
| <b>PRE03</b>       | If the programme legal reference is for FA (progLegalRef = N112A), the restriction/exception must be reported using the FAREstExc hierarchy. If there are no restrictions or exceptions to report, the option 'No restriction/exception to report' must be selected within the same hierarchy. | The legal reference specifies that FA data is reported (progLegalRef = N112A), but either the field is empty, or data input is not reportable under FAREstExc hierarchy.<br>If 'No restriction/exception to report' ADD00881A should be reported. | Error         | Active |
| <b>PRE04</b>       | If the legal reference is for FF (progLegalRef = N113A), the restriction/exception must be reported using the FFRestExc hierarchy. If there are no restrictions or exceptions to report, the option 'No restriction/exception to report' must be selected within the same hierarchy.           | The legal reference specified that FF data is reported (progLegalRef = N113A), but either the field is empty, or data input is not reportable under FFRestExc hierarchy.<br>If 'No restriction/exception to report' ADD00881A should be reported. | Error         | Active |
| <b>PRE05</b>       | The code for the substance reported (paramCode) must belong to the food additives (addAnalysis) and/or food flavourings (flavAnalysis) hierarchy of the PARAM catalogue.                                                                                                                       | The code for the substance reported (paramCode) does not belong to the food additives (addAnalysis) and/or food flavourings (flavAnalysis) hierarchy of the PARAM catalogue.                                                                      | Error         | Active |
| <b>PRE06</b>       | Only 'No-presence' data can be reported here (presenceAdded='No, not present on label/not added' – C20A). If a positive presence is reported, then the                                                                                                                                         | Positive presence was reported (presenceAdded=C19A or C05A), which is not allowed in this data                                                                                                                                                    | Error         | Active |

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|              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                                                                                                                                        |       |        |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|--------|
|              | information should be accompanied by an analytical/use level value and a different data model should be used.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | model. If a positive presence is reported, then the information should be accompanied by an analytical/use level value in another data model.          |       |        |
| <b>PRE07</b> | The function of the substance (functionOf) must be reported if the programme legal reference (progLegRef) is equal to the additive domain (N112A).                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | The function of the substance (functionOf) is missing, even though the programme legal reference (progLegRef) is equal to the additive domain (N112A). | Error | Active |
| <b>PRE08</b> | The food legislative classes facet (F33) of the sample must be reported under the coded description of the matrix (sampMatCode) if it is not implicitly assigned. The physical state facet (F03) must be reported under the coded description of the matrix (sampMatCode) if the product category/food refers to the following food legislative categories: <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• <b>01.5</b> Dehydrated milk as defined by Directive 2001/114/EC</li> <li>• <b>01.6</b> Cream and cream powder</li> <li>• <b>01.8</b> Dairy analogues, including beverage whiteners</li> <li>• <b>01.9</b> Edible caseinates</li> <li>• <b>01.10</b> Milk-based drinks and similar products intended for young children</li> <li>• <b>06.3</b> Breakfast cereals</li> <li>• <b>12.5</b> Soups and broths</li> <li>• <b>12.6</b> Sauces</li> <li>• <b>13</b> Foods intended for specific groups as defined by Regulation (EU) No 609/2013</li> <li>• <b>14.1.2</b> Fruit juices as defined by Directive 2001/112/EC and vegetable juices</li> <li>• <b>14.1.3</b> Fruit nectars as defined by Directive 2001/112/EC and vegetable nectars and similar products</li> <li>• <b>14.1.4</b> Flavoured drinks</li> <li>• <b>14.1.5</b> Coffee, coffee and chicory extracts, tea, herbal- and fruit-infusions; coffee substitutes, coffee mixes and mixes for 'hot beverages'</li> </ul> | The food legislative classes facet (F33) of the sample is null.                                                                                        | Error | Active |
| <b>PRE09</b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | The physical state facet (F03) of the sample is not reported for this specific food legislative category.                                              | Error | Active |

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- 17. Food supplements as defined in Directive 2002/46/EC of the European Parliament and of the Council excluding food supplements for infants and young children

|              |                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |         |        |
|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|--------|
| <b>PRE10</b> | The reported values about presence and addition of FA/FF (presenceAdded) must be meaningful. "Yes, present on label/added" (C19A) and "No, not present on label/not added" (C20A) cannot be submitted in the same record. | The reported values in presenceAdded must be meaningful. "Yes, present on label/added" (C19A) and "No, not present on label/not added" (C20A) cannot be submitted in the same record.                                   | Error   | Active |
| <b>PRE11</b> | The combination of repCountry, sampCountry, sampY, sampM, sampD, sampMatCode, sampMatInfo.brandName, and sampMatInfo.manuf must be constant for all the records with the same sample taken identification code (sampId).  | The combination of repCountry, sampCountry, sampY, sampM, sampD, sampMatCode, sampMatInfo.brandName, and sampMatInfo.manuf is not constant for all the records with the same sample taken identification code (sampId). | Error   | Active |
| <b>PRE12</b> | The combination of parameter code (paramCode) and sample taken identification code (sampId) needs to be unique.                                                                                                           | The combination of parameter code (paramCode) and sample taken identification code (sampId) is not unique.                                                                                                              | Error   | Active |
| <b>PRE13</b> | If the progLegRef is N112A, then the substance reported (paramCode) must belong to the hierarchy addAnalysis.                                                                                                             | The reported paramCode does not belong to the progLegRef N112A.                                                                                                                                                         | Error   | Active |
| <b>PRE14</b> | If the progLegRef is N113A, then the substance reported (paramCode) must belong to the hierarchy flavAnalysis.                                                                                                            | The reported paramCode does not belong to the progLegRef N113A.                                                                                                                                                         | Error   | Active |
| <b>PRE15</b> | If the reported sampMatCode contains an implicit additive/flavouring food legislative category (F33), then the explicit additive/flavouring F33 is not needed.                                                            | The reported sampMatCode contains an explicit additive/flavouring food legislative category (F33), even if the implicit additive/flavouring F33 is present.                                                             | Warning | Active |
| <b>PRE16</b> | If the data element reporting year is reported (repYear) must be equal to the current year of the data collection.                                                                                                        | The reporting year is not equal to the current year of the data collection.                                                                                                                                             | Error   | Active |
| <b>PRE17</b> | The combination of values in sampling day, sampling month and sampling year is not a valid date.                                                                                                                          | The combination of values in sampD, sampM and sampY is not a valid date.                                                                                                                                                | Error   | Active |



## References

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- European Food Safety Authority, Gutiérrez Linares A, Salvatore S, Belmonte L and Gómez Ruiz JA, 2025b. Reporting guidance for 'No presence' data on food additives and food flavourings at sample level - 2025. *EFSA supporting publication* 2025: 22(2):EN-9284. 20 pp. doi: [10.2903/sp.efsa.2025.EN-9284](https://doi.org/10.2903/sp.efsa.2025.EN-9284).

## Abbreviations

|         |                                          |
|---------|------------------------------------------|
| BR      | Business Rules                           |
| ChemMon | EFSA Chemical Monitoring data collection |
| DCF     | Data Collection Framework                |
| DM      | Data Model                               |
| DP      | Data Provider                            |
| EC      | European Commission                      |
| EFSA    | European Food Safety Authority           |
| FA      | Food Additive                            |
| FF      | Food Flavouring                          |
| MS      | EU Member States                         |
| RC      | Reporting Countries                      |
| sDWH    | EFSA scientific DataWareHouse            |
| SSD1    | EFSA Standard Sample Description (ver.1) |
| SSD2    | EFSA Standard Sample Description (ver.2) |
| XML     | Extensible Markup Language               |